Activity 1.5

Keep a slice of bread in a clean plastic tray or plate. Wet the surface with little water. Leave the setup for 3 or 4 days. Observe the mouldy growth on the surface of the bread. Using a needle remove some mycelium and place it on a slide and stain the mycelium using lactophenol cotton blue. Observe the mycelium and sporangium under the microscope and record your observation and identify the fungi and its group based on characteristic features.

1.5.6 Mycorrhizae

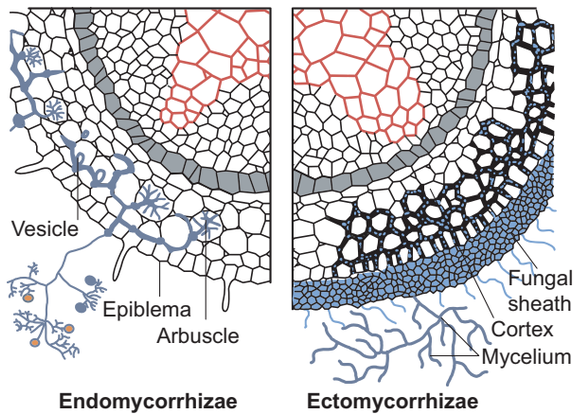


Figure 1.24: T.S. of root showing mycorrhizae

The symbiotic association between fungal mycelium and roots of plants is called as mycorrhizae. In this relationship fungi absorb nutrition from the root and in turn the hyphal network of mycorrhizae forming fungi helps the plant to absorb water and mineral nutrients from the soil (Figure 1.24). Mycorrhizae is classified into three types (Table 1.12)

Importance of Mycorrhizae

- Helps to derive nutrition in *Monotropa*, a saprophytic angiosperm,
- Improves the availability of minerals and water to the plants.
- Provides drought resistance to the plants
- Protects roots of higher plants from the attack of plant pathogens

1.5.7 Lichens

The symbiotic association between algae and fungi is called lichens. The algal partner is called Phycobiont or Photobiont., and the fungal partner is called Mycobiont. Algae provide nutrition for fungal partner in turn fungi provide protection and also help to fix the thallus to the substratum through rhizinae. Asexual reproduction takes place through fragmentation, Soredia and Isidia. Phycobionts reproduce by akinetes, hormogonia, aplanospore etc., Mycobionts undergo sexual reproduction and produce ascocarps.

Classification

- Based on the habitat lichens are classified into following types: **Corticolous**(

Table 1.12: Types of Mycorrhizae

Ectomycorrhizae	Endomycorrhizae	Ectendomycorrhizae
The fungal mycelium forms a dense sheath around the root called mantle. The hyphal network penetrate the intercellular spaces of the epidermis and cortex to form Hartig net. Example: *Pisolithus tinctorius*	The hyphae grows mainly inside the roots, penetrate the outer cortical cells of the plant root. A small portion of the mycelium is found outside the root. This form is also called Vesicular Arbuscular Mycorrhizal fungi (VAM Fungi) due to the presence of Vesicle or arbuscle like haustoria 1. Arbuscular mycorrhizae(AM) Example: *Gigaspora* 2. Ericoid mycorrhizae -Example: *Oidiodendron* 3. Orchid mycorrhizae -Example: *Rhizoctonia*	The fungi form both mantle and also penetrates the cortical cells.

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